Babur mentions an interesting thing in the *Baburnama*. He says, ‘In Kābul can be had the products of Khurāsān, Rūm, ‘Irāq and Chīn (China); while it is Hindustan’s own market.’[*]

c. Products and climate of Kābul

The districts of hot and cold climate in the country of Kābul were close to each other.

In a single day, a person could journey from the city of Kābul to a place where snow was a rare sight, or they could reach a location where freezing temperatures persisted for two sidereal hours, unless the weather was exceptionally hot and prevented snow from accumulating.

The areas surrounding the town offered a variety of fruits suited to both hot and cold climates. In the colder regions, within the town itself, one could find grapes, pomegranates, apricots, apples, quinces, pears, peaches, plums, sinjids, almonds, and walnuts. Babur had brought the cuttings of the ālū-bālū there and had them planted which he observed to have grown and done well. People transported various fruits suited for hot climates into the town. These fruits included oranges, citrons, amlūk (diospyros lotus), and sugarcane, the latter of which Babur personally had brought and cultivated there. Additionally, from Nijr-au (Nijr-water), they brought jīl-ghūza, and, from the hill-tracts they bring a lots of honey. Beehives are actively employed, with the exception being Ghaznī, which does not supply any honey. The rhubarb from the Kābul district was of high quality, and its quinces and plums were exceptionally good. The badrang from this region was also noteworthy. It produced an excellent grape known as the water-grape. The wines from Kābul were robust and flavorful, particularly those from the Khwāja Khāwand Sa‘īd hill area, which were renowned for their potency. Babur reiterates the commendations of others regarding these wines as below in the *Baburnama*:—

The flavor of the wine a drinker knows;

What chance have sober men to know it?

Kābul’s soil was not highly productive when it came to grain; a four or five-fold yield was considered good in that region. The melons from Kābul were not top-tier, but they could be of decent quality when cultivated from Khurāsān seed.

The climate was exceptionally pleasant, and if there was another place in the world equally pleasant, it remained unknown. Even during hot